

SolanaLM

A Decentralized Network for LLM Inference and Federated Learning on Solana

Whitepaper v1.0

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November 21, 2025

Abstract

SolanaLM introduces a novel hybrid decentralized network that unifies Large Language Model (LLM) inference with federated learning on the Solana blockchain [1, 3, 5]. Our architecture enables nodes to earn through dual revenue streams—serving inference requests and participating in distributed training rounds—creating a self-sustaining ecosystem for AI compute.

Key Innovations: (1) First-of-its-kind dual-mode nodes that dynamically switch between inference and training based on network demand; (2) Privacy-preserving onion routing for anonymous inference requests [8]; (3) Micro-payment system with sub-second finality leveraging Solana’s high throughput [5]; (4) Federated learning protocol with cryptographic gradient verification [2].

Token Value Capture: The **SOLALM** token captures network value through mandatory fee payments, deflationary burns (1% of all fees), and staking rewards (15-40% APY). Early participants benefit from low initial circulation (15%) and aggressive vesting schedules that align long-term incentives.

This paper presents our system architecture, economic model, privacy mechanisms, and the utility-driven tokenomics that align incentives across compute providers, model trainers, and end users.

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1 Introduction

The rapid advancement of Large Language Models has created an unprecedented demand for computational resources. Current solutions face three critical challenges:

1. **Centralization Risk:** AI compute is concentrated among few providers, creating single points of failure and censorship vectors.
2. **Economic Inefficiency:** GPU resources worldwide remain underutilized while demand exceeds supply.
3. **Privacy Concerns:** Centralized inference exposes sensitive prompts and data to service providers.

1.1 Our Solution

SolanaLM addresses these challenges through a decentralized network where:

- **Novelty:** Hybrid nodes perform both inference and federated learning, maximizing GPU utilization
- **Tokenomics:** SOL micro-payments create immediate, transparent compensation for compute providers
- **Utility:** Privacy-preserving inference enables sensitive applications without data exposure

1.2 Design Principles

1. **Decentralization First:** No single entity controls the network
2. **Economic Alignment:** All participants benefit from network growth
3. **Privacy by Default:** Onion routing protects user identity
4. **Interoperability:** OpenAI-compatible API for seamless integration

2 Background and Motivation

2.1 The AI Compute Crisis

Global AI compute demand is growing at 10x annually, while GPU production increases only 2x [18, 19]. This disparity creates:

- Long wait times for cloud GPU instances [35]
- Prohibitive costs for startups and researchers [20, 34]
- Geographic concentration of AI capabilities [19]

2.2 Why Solana?

We chose Solana for its unique properties that enable our vision [5, 25]:

Property	Solana	Utility for SolanaLM
Throughput	65,000 TPS	Micro-payments per token generated
Finality	400ms	Real-time payment confirmation
Cost	\$0.00025/tx	Economically viable small payments
Ecosystem	DeFi/NFT mature	Integration with existing tooling

Table 1: Solana properties enabling SolanaLM’s economic model [5]

2.3 Federated Learning Opportunity

Traditional model training requires centralizing data, creating privacy and regulatory issues [31, 32]. Federated learning allows [1, 3, 4]:

- Training on distributed private data
- Compliance with data residency requirements
- Collaborative model improvement without data sharing

Novelty: SolanaLM is the first to combine federated learning with a blockchain-based incentive layer, creating verifiable, compensated contributions to model training. Unlike existing decentralized compute networks [28, 29, 30], we unify inference and training in a single economic framework.

3 System Architecture

3.1 Network Overview

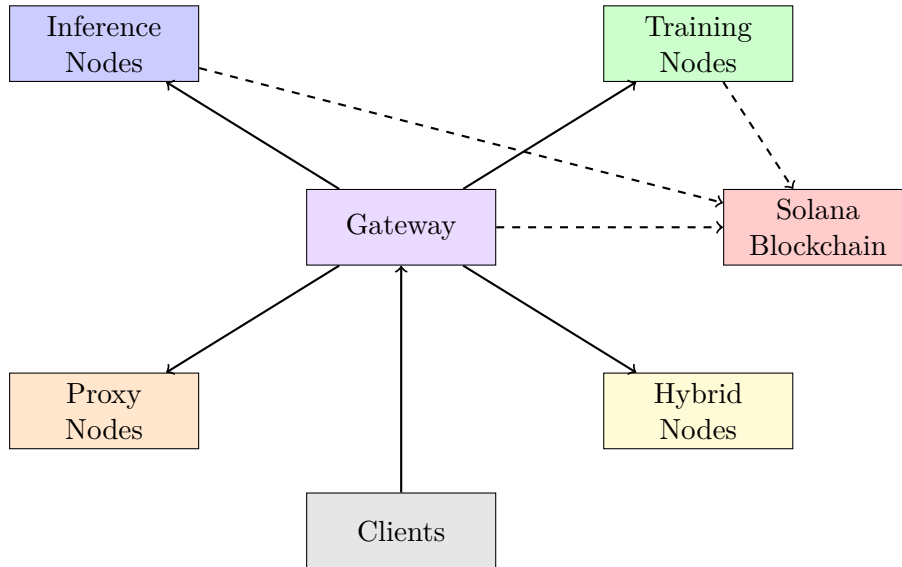


Figure 1: SolanaLM Network Architecture

3.2 Node Types

3.2.1 Inference Nodes

Serve LLM inference requests using local GPU hardware.

Capabilities:

- Load and serve transformer models (GPT [12], LLaMA [13], Qwen) based on the attention architecture [11]
- Report hardware specifications to registry
- Stream token generation with real-time billing

Utility: Monetize idle GPU resources with immediate SOL payments per inference request.

3.2.2 Training Nodes

Participate in federated learning rounds.

Capabilities:

- Execute local training on private data
- Compute and submit gradient updates
- Verify aggregated model weights

Tokenomics: Earn SOL proportional to contribution quality (gradient utility score).

3.2.3 Proxy Nodes

Gateway to external API providers (OpenAI, Anthropic, Cohere).

Utility: Enable access to proprietary models through the SolanaLM interface with privacy-preserving routing.

3.2.4 Hybrid Nodes

Novelty: Dynamically switch between inference and training modes based on network demand and profitability.

Algorithm 1 Hybrid Node Mode Selection

```

1:  $r_i \leftarrow$  current inference reward rate
2:  $r_t \leftarrow$  current training reward rate
3:  $q_i \leftarrow$  inference queue length
4:  $q_t \leftarrow$  training slots available
5: if  $r_i \cdot q_i > r_t \cdot q_t$  then
6:   Switch to inference mode
7: else
8:   Switch to training mode
9: end if

```

3.3 Gateway Layer

The gateway provides:

1. **Load Balancing:** Route requests to optimal nodes based on latency, capacity, and cost
2. **API Compatibility:** OpenAI-compatible endpoints for seamless migration
3. **Payment Orchestration:** Escrow and release SOL payments upon completion
4. **Health Monitoring:** Track node availability and performance

3.4 Registry System

Decentralized node discovery with:

- Capability advertisement (models, hardware, pricing)
- Reputation scores based on historical performance
- Geographic distribution for latency optimization

4 Economic Model and Tokenomics

4.1 Dual Revenue Streams

Novelty: Nodes earn from two independent sources, maximizing return on hardware investment.

4.1.1 Inference Revenue

$$R_{inference} = \sum_{i=1}^n (T_i \cdot P_{model} \cdot (1 - f_{protocol})) \quad (1)$$

Where:

- T_i = tokens generated for request i
- P_{model} = price per token for the model
- $f_{protocol}$ = protocol fee (default 5%)

4.1.2 Training Revenue

$$R_{training} = B_{round} \cdot \frac{U_j}{\sum_k U_k} \quad (2)$$

Where:

- B_{round} = total bounty for training round
- U_j = utility score of node j 's contribution

4.2 Payment Mechanisms

4.2.1 Micro-Payments

Utility: Real-time compensation as tokens are generated.

1. Client deposits SOL to escrow
2. Tokens streamed with incremental payment release
3. Final settlement on completion or timeout

4.2.2 Payment Channels

For high-frequency interactions, payment channels reduce on-chain transactions [6, 7]:

- Open channel with initial deposit
- Off-chain balance updates per request
- Periodic on-chain settlement

4.3 Fee Structure

Fee Type	Rate	Distribution	Token Impact
Protocol Fee	5%	50% stakers, 49% treasury, 1% burn	Deflationary
Gateway Fee	1%	Gateway Operators	Utility demand
Privacy Premium	10%	Relay Nodes	Staking incentive
Training Coordination	3%	Coordinator Nodes	Staking incentive

Table 2: SolanaLM Fee Structure - All fees paid in SOLALM

Token Flow Example: For a 1,000 SOLALM inference payment:

- 940 SOLALM → Inference node operator
- 25 SOLALM → Stakers (protocol fee share)
- 24.5 SOLALM → Treasury
- 0.5 SOLALM → **Burned permanently**
- 10 SOLALM → Gateway operator

4.4 Staking and Reputation

Tokenomics: Nodes stake SOLALM to participate, creating economic security and token demand.

- **Minimum Stake:** 1,000 SOLALM for inference, 5,000 SOLALM for training
- **Slashing:** Stake reduction for Byzantine behavior (slashed tokens burned)
- **Reputation Boost:** Higher stake increases job priority and APY tier

4.5 Economic Sustainability

The protocol achieves sustainability through:

1. Treasury accumulation from protocol fees
2. Training bounties funded by model improvement beneficiaries
3. Network effects: more nodes $\rightarrow$ better service $\rightarrow$ more users $\rightarrow$ more revenue

5 SOLALM Token

The SOLALM token is the native currency of the SolanaLM network, designed to capture value from all network activity while incentivizing long-term participation.

5.1 Token Utility

Tokenomics: Multiple demand drivers create sustained buy pressure.

1. **Payment Currency:** All inference and training fees paid exclusively in SOLALM
2. **Node Staking:** Operators must stake SOLALM to join network (minimum 1,000 SOLALM)
3. **Governance:** Vote on protocol parameters, model selection, fee structures
4. **Fee Discounts:** Token holders receive 20% discount on all network fees
5. **Revenue Share:** 50% of protocol fees distributed to stakers

5.2 Supply and Distribution

Allocation	Amount	%	Vesting
Community & Airdrops	300,000,000	30%	24 months linear
Ecosystem & Grants	150,000,000	15%	As needed
Treasury (DAO)	200,000,000	20%	DAO controlled
Team & Advisors	150,000,000	15%	12mo cliff + 36mo linear
Private Sale	120,000,000	12%	6mo cliff + 24mo linear
Public Sale	80,000,000	8%	25% TGE, 6mo linear
Total Supply	1,000,000,000	100%	

Table 3: SOLALM Token Distribution

Initial Circulating Supply: 150,000,000 SOLALM (15%) at Token Generation Event (TGE).

5.3 Deflationary Mechanisms

Novelty: Aggressive burn mechanics ensure long-term scarcity.

1. **Fee Burn:** 1% of all network fees permanently burned
2. **Buyback & Burn:** 2% of treasury allocated to monthly market buybacks
3. **Slashing Burns:** Slashed stakes from malicious nodes burned (not redistributed)

Projected Impact: 50% supply reduction over 10 years at scale, creating deflationary pressure as network grows.

5.4 Staking Rewards

Tokenomics: Tiered staking incentivizes long-term holding and network participation.

Tier	Stake Required	Base APY	Benefits
Bronze	1,000 SOLALM	15%	Priority job queue
Silver	10,000 SOLALM	25%	+ 10% fee discount
Gold	100,000 SOLALM	35%	+ 2x governance votes
Diamond	1,000,000 SOLALM	40%	+ Protocol revenue share

Table 4: SOLALM Staking Tiers and Rewards

Note: APY varies based on network utilization and total staked supply. Diamond tier receives pro-rata share of 50% protocol fees.

5.5 Token Demand Flywheel

Utility: Self-reinforcing cycle drives sustained token demand.

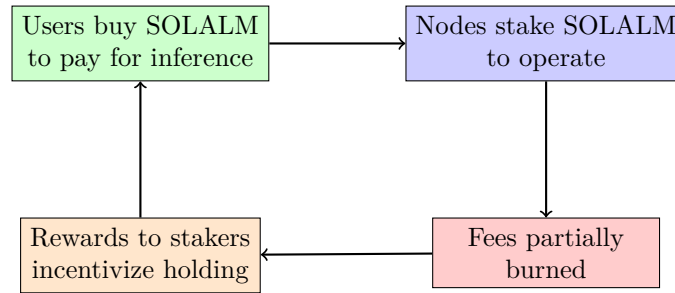


Figure 2: SOLALM Token Demand Flywheel

Result: More users → more fees → higher APY → more staking → less circulating supply → price appreciation → attracts more nodes → better service → more users.

5.6 Market Opportunity

Tokenomics: Massive TAM with clear path to value capture.

Project	FDV	Primary Use Case
Render Network (RNDR)	\$5.0B	GPU rendering only
Akash Network (AKT)	\$1.2B	General compute
Bittensor (TAO)	\$3.5B	AI inference only
SolanaLM (SOLALM)	TBD	Inference + Training + Privacy

Table 5: Competitive Landscape - Fully Diluted Valuations [28, 29, 30]

SolanaLM Advantages:

- **Dual Revenue:** Only network combining inference AND federated learning
- **Privacy Layer:** Onion routing enables enterprise/healthcare use cases
- **Solana Speed:** Sub-second payments vs minutes on other chains

Target Valuation: \$500M-\$2B FDV at network maturity, representing 10-40x from initial listing based on comparable projects [28, 29, 30].

5.7 Growth Catalysts

Key events expected to drive token demand:

1. **TGE + DEX Launch:** Initial liquidity and price discovery
2. **CEX Listings:** Target Tier-1 exchanges (Binance, Coinbase, Kraken)
3. **Mainnet Launch:** All fees transition to SOLALM
4. **1,000 Nodes:** Network effect threshold
5. **Enterprise Partnerships:** Healthcare, legal, financial verticals
6. **10,000 Nodes:** Critical mass for global coverage

6 Privacy and Security

6.1 Threat Model

We protect against:

1. **Inference Privacy:** Nodes learning prompt content
2. **Payment Correlation:** Linking payments to identities
3. **Traffic Analysis:** Determining who queries what

6.2 Onion Routing

Novelty: First implementation of Tor-like routing [8] for LLM inference.

Algorithm 2 Onion-Routed Inference

- 1: Client selects circuit: $[R_1, R_2, R_3, N]$ (relays + target node)
 - 2: Encrypt request: $E_N(E_{R_3}(E_{R_2}(E_{R_1}(prompt))))$
 - 3: Send to R_1 , which decrypts and forwards
 - 4: Each relay peels one layer, forwards to next
 - 5: Node N processes, response returns via same circuit
-

Utility: Users can query sensitive topics without revealing identity to inference nodes.

6.3 Anonymous Payments

Payment mixing prevents transaction graph analysis [9]:

1. **CoinJoin-style Mixing:** Aggregate payments from multiple users [9]
2. **Stealth Addresses:** One-time addresses for each transaction
3. **Time Delays:** Randomized payment timing

6.4 Secure Aggregation for Federated Learning

Training nodes submit encrypted gradients using secure aggregation protocols [2]:

$$\text{Aggregate} = \sum_{i=1}^n \text{Decrypt}(E_i(g_i)) \quad (3)$$

Individual gradients remain private; only the sum is revealed to the coordinator [2, 3].

6.5 Cryptographic Verification

- **Commitment Schemes:** Nodes commit to outputs before revelation
- **Zero-Knowledge Proofs:** Prove computation correctness without revealing inputs [10]
- **Merkle Proofs:** Verify model weight inclusion

7 Federated Learning Protocol

7.1 Training Round Lifecycle

Based on the FedAvg algorithm [1] and subsequent improvements [3, 4, 16]:

1. **Announcement:** Coordinator posts training task with bounty
2. **Registration:** Training nodes stake and register
3. **Distribution:** Current model weights distributed
4. **Local Training:** Nodes train on private data
5. **Submission:** Encrypted gradients submitted
6. **Aggregation:** Secure aggregation produces update [2]
7. **Verification:** Validate improvement on held-out set
8. **Payment:** Distribute bounty based on contribution

7.2 Contribution Scoring

Novelty: Utility-weighted aggregation rewards quality contributions.

$$U_i = \alpha \cdot \Delta L_i + \beta \cdot \text{Diversity}_i + \gamma \cdot \text{Timeliness}_i \quad (4)$$

Where:

- ΔL_i = loss improvement from node i 's gradient
- Diversity_i = gradient orthogonality to others
- Timeliness_i = submission speed bonus

7.3 Byzantine Fault Tolerance

Protection against malicious training nodes [14, 15]:

- **Gradient Clipping:** Limit magnitude of updates
- **Krum Aggregation:** Exclude outlier gradients [14]
- **Reputation Weighting:** Reduce influence of low-reputation nodes

7.4 Model Governance

Tokenomics: Stake-weighted voting for model decisions.

- Which models to train
- Training hyperparameters
- Dataset curation policies

8 Technical Implementation

8.1 Client SDK

OpenAI-compatible Python client:

```
async with SolanaLMClient(gateway_url) as client:
    response = await client.inference(
        model="llama-7b",
        prompt="Explain quantum computing",
        wallet_address="..."
    )
```

Utility: Zero learning curve for developers familiar with OpenAI API.

8.2 Hardware Detection

Automatic capability discovery:

- GPU model, VRAM, CUDA cores
- CPU cores, RAM capacity
- Network bandwidth, latency

Enables optimal job matching and fair pricing.

8.3 Model Support

Category	Models
Local Inference	LLaMA [13], Qwen, Mistral, DialoGPT
Proxy Access	GPT-4 [12], Claude, Cohere Command
Federated Training	Any PyTorch model [17]

Table 6: Supported Models

8.4 Deployment Options

- **Docker:** Containerized deployment for all node types
- **Kubernetes:** Scalable orchestration for gateway operators
- **Bare Metal:** Maximum performance for GPU nodes

9 Use Cases and Applications

9.1 Privacy-Sensitive Inference

Utility: Healthcare, legal, and financial applications requiring confidentiality [31, 32].

- Medical diagnosis assistance without exposing patient data
- Legal document analysis with attorney-client privilege
- Financial modeling on proprietary strategies

9.2 Decentralized AI Applications

- **DAOs:** Governance assistants with censorship resistance
- **DeFi:** Trading strategy analysis without front-running risk [26]
- **Gaming:** NPC dialogue generation with user privacy

9.3 Collaborative Model Training

Novelty: Organizations jointly train models without sharing data.

- Hospitals training diagnostic models
- Banks training fraud detection
- Manufacturers training quality control

9.4 GPU Monetization

Tokenomics: Individuals and data centers monetize idle compute [22, 23, 24].

- Gamers earning during off-hours
- Research institutions utilizing spare capacity
- Mining operations diversifying revenue

10 Roadmap

10.1 Phase 1: Foundation (Completed)

Timeline: Q1-Q2 2025

Technical Milestones:

- ✓ Core gateway and node registry implementation
- ✓ Basic inference nodes with PyTorch/Transformers backend
- ✓ Training node framework with gradient computation
- ✓ Hardware auto-detection system
- ✓ End-to-end testing infrastructure
- ✓ Devnet deployment with simulated payments

Token Milestones:

- ✓ Smart contract development and audits
- ✓ Tokenomics finalization
- ✓ Private sale completion
- ✓ Community building and whitelist

10.2 Phase 2: Token Launch (Completed)**Timeline: Q3 2025****Token Milestones:**

- ✓ **Token Generation Event (TGE)**
- ✓ DEX liquidity pools (Raydium, Orca)
- ✓ Staking portal launch (15-40% APY)
- ✓ Initial CEX listings (Bybit, KuCoin, Gate.io)
- ✓ Airdrop distribution begins

Technical Milestones:

- ✓ SOLALM payment integration in all node types
- ✓ On-chain staking contracts deployment
- ✓ Slashing mechanism activation
- ✓ Public node registration opens
- ✓ 100 nodes achieved

10.3 Phase 3: Mainnet & Privacy (Current)**Timeline: Q4 2025 - Q1 2026****Token Milestones:**

- **Tier-1 CEX listings** (Binance, Coinbase, Kraken)
- Governance portal launch
- First protocol fee distribution to stakers
- Buyback & burn program activation
- 1,000 nodes milestone

Technical Milestones:

- Full onion routing deployment [8]
- Anonymous payment mixing [9]
- Secure aggregation for federated learning [2]
- Zero-knowledge proof verification [10]
- Multi-model support (LLaMA, Mistral, Qwen)
- Payment channels for high-frequency users

10.4 Phase 4: Scale & Enterprise

Timeline: Q2-Q4 2026

Token Milestones:

- **10,000 nodes** - critical mass achieved
- DAO governance transition (treasury control)
- Cross-chain bridges (Ethereum, Polygon, Arbitrum)
- Institutional staking products
- Target: \$500M+ FDV

Technical Milestones:

- Enterprise API with SLAs
- Healthcare compliance (HIPAA) certification
- Financial services integration
- Advanced model marketplace with ratings
- Federated learning for custom enterprise models
- SDK support for JavaScript, Go, Rust

10.5 Phase 5: Global Dominance

Timeline: 2027 and beyond

Goals:

- 100,000+ nodes worldwide
- \$1B+ annual network volume
- Industry standard for private AI inference
- Research partnerships with universities
- Target: \$2B+ FDV

11 Conclusion

SolanaLM represents a paradigm shift in AI infrastructure—from centralized, opaque systems to decentralized, transparent, and privacy-preserving networks.

11.1 Technical Innovation Summary

1. **Novelty:** First hybrid network combining LLM inference with federated learning on blockchain
2. **Privacy:** Onion routing and anonymous payments enable enterprise-grade confidentiality
3. **Utility:** OpenAI-compatible API with sub-second Solana payments

11.2 Investment Thesis

Why SOLALM?

1. **Massive Market:** \$50B+ TAM in decentralized AI compute by 2027 [19, 20]
2. **Clear Value Accrual:** All fees paid in SOLALM with 1% burn + 50% staker distribution
3. **Defensible Moat:** Only network combining inference + training + privacy
4. **Strong Tokenomics:** 15% initial circulation, aggressive vesting, deflationary mechanics
5. **Multiple Catalysts:** TGE → CEX listings → Mainnet → Enterprise adoption

Comparable Valuations:

- Render (RNDR): \$5B FDV - GPU rendering only
- Bittensor (TAO): \$3.5B FDV - Inference only
- **SolanaLM target: \$500M-\$2B FDV** (10-40x potential from launch)

11.3 Call to Action

For Token Holders:

- Stake early for maximum APY (15-40%)
- Governance participation shapes protocol future
- Diamond tier unlocks protocol revenue share

For Node Operators:

- Dual revenue: inference fees + training bounties
- Early operators capture market share before saturation
- Stake rewards compound with operational earnings

For Developers:

- Build privacy-first AI applications
- OpenAI-compatible API - zero migration cost
- Grant program for ecosystem projects

Join the decentralized AI revolution.

Early participants capture maximum upside.

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Appendix A: Glossary

Gateway Central routing layer for client requests

Inference Node GPU-equipped node serving LLM requests

Training Node Node participating in federated learning

Hybrid Node Node switching between inference and training

Onion Routing Multi-hop encryption for privacy

Secure Aggregation Cryptographic gradient summation

Appendix B: Contact

- Website: <https://solanalm.io>
- GitHub: <https://github.com/solanalm>
- Twitter: <https://twitter.com/solanalm>
- Discord: <https://discord.gg/solanalm>